Adaptability questions

Design Gurus

Amazon publishes its framework. Most companies do not, which makes them harder to prepare for and, in practice, slightly more forgiving.

Google

Google assesses four areas across the loop. Two are technical. The other two are what its behavioral round is for.

General cognitive ability is about how you approach an unfamiliar problem, including how you decide what to do when the problem is not well defined.

Googleyness and leadership is the one people ask about. It covers working with ambiguity and acting without formal authority. It also covers being comfortable when you are challenged, and doing what the situation needs rather than what your title says.

Two practical points. Google cares about emergent leadership, which means leading without being the manager. A story where you had authority and used it counts for less here than one where you had none and moved the work anyway. Its interviewers are also trained to probe reasoning, so expect more follow-ups about why you chose something than about what you chose.

Meta often runs its behavioral round as a single interview covering both your history and how you work. Its published values change wording from time to time, so prepare for the themes rather than the phrasing.

The themes stay consistent. Moving fast, and specifically what you shipped and how quickly. Direct feedback, both giving it and taking it. Working across teams with no reporting line between you. And impact, stated as a number.

Meta asks about conflict more directly than most companies, and it expects a real one. A story where the disagreement resolved politely and nothing was at stake reads as an avoided question.

Microsoft

Microsoft's behavioral questions cluster around what it calls a growth mindset. In practice that means three things. What you learned from something that went wrong, how you respond to feedback, and how you help other people improve.

Microsoft also runs a final conversation with a senior person, often called the "as appropriate" round. That one is less about your history and more about how you think, and whether you fit the specific team. Treat it as a conversation, but bring the same stories.

When a company publishes nothing

Most companies you interview with will have no published framework. Three sources are still

available.

Read the job description properly. The requirements are usually the criteria, written for a different audience.

Read the company's engineering blog. What a company chooses to write about tells you what it values.

Ask your recruiter which areas the loop covers. They will usually tell you, and almost nobody asks.

If none of those helps, prepare against the nine categories from the earlier chapter. Every company framework is a reordering of the same underlying qualities.